Orbital Payments API - Reference (v2.4)

1. Authentication

All requests must include a bearer token in the Authorization header. Tokens are issued by POST /v2/auth/token and expire after 3600 seconds. Refresh tokens are valid for 30 days and are single-use: each refresh invalidates the previous refresh token.

Requests without a valid token return HTTP 401 with error code auth_token_invalid. Requests with an expired token return HTTP 401 with error code auth_token_expired.

2. Rate Limiting

The default rate limit is 120 requests per minute per API key. Bulk endpoints under /v2/bulk/ have a separate limit of 10 requests per minute. Exceeding a limit returns HTTP 429 with a Retry-After header expressed in seconds. The limit can be raised to 600 requests per minute on the Enterprise plan by contacting support.

Rate limit state is reported on every response through three headers: X-RateLimit-Limit, X-RateLimit-Remaining, and X-RateLimit-Reset.

3. Payouts

POST /v2/payouts creates a payout. Required fields are amount_cents (integer), currency (ISO 4217), and destination_id (string). The optional idempotency_key field prevents duplicate payouts when a request is retried; keys are retained for 24 hours.

GET /v2/payouts/{payout_id} retrieves a single payout.
GET /v2/payouts lists payouts, paginated with limit (max 100) and cursor.
POST /v2/payouts/{payout_id}/cancel cancels a payout that is still pending.

A payout moves through the states: pending, processing, paid, failed, cancelled. Only payouts in the pending state can be cancelled.

4. Webhooks

Webhook payloads are signed with HMAC-SHA256 using your endpoint secret. The signature is sent in the X-Orbital-Signature header. Verify it before trusting the payload. Failed deliveries are retried 8 times with exponential backoff over roughly 24 hours.

Supported events: payout.created, payout.paid, payout.failed, payout.cancelled, and account.updated.